

# Word family: \*\*tea / teas / tea-related compounds\*\*

\*\*Base word:\*\* tea

\*\*Plural:\*\* teas

\*\*Part of speech:\*\* mainly noun ( 名詞 )

\*\*Useful compounds/extensions:\*\* tea leaves, tea bag, teapot, teacup, tea break, afternoon tea, high tea, herbal tea, green tea, black tea, tea ceremony, tea room, tea party, not my cup of tea, spill the tea

Your passage contains:

> “Whenever I visit, she insists on making \*\*tea\*\* and cutting fruit for everyone...”

Here, \*\*tea\*\* means:

\*\*a hot drink made by soaking tea leaves in hot water.\*\*

---

## Meaning in this passage

In:

> \*\*making tea\*\*

\*\*tea\*\* refers to:

\*\*the drink prepared from tea leaves and hot water, often served socially to guests or family members.\*\*

Your grandmother is not merely preparing a beverage.

In the context, making tea is also part of her habitual way of:

- \* welcoming people;
- \* caring for them;
- \* serving them;
- \* showing affection.

But the lexical meaning of \*\*tea\*\* itself remains:

\*\*the drink.\*\*

\*\*Meaning:\*\* A drink made by infusing tea leaves in hot water.

\*\*繁體中文:\*\* \*\*用茶葉加入熱水沖泡而成的飲品；這裡指外婆為家人泡茶\*\*

**\*\*中文翻譯：\*\***

> “She insists on making tea and cutting fruit for everyone.”

「她總是堅持為大家**\*\*泡茶\*\***、切水果。」

So:

**\*\*make tea = 泡茶 / 準備茶飲\*\***

This is the exact passage meaning.

---

# 1. **\*\*tea = drink made from tea leaves ( 茶飲 ) — 茶 ; 茶水\*\***

This is the exact core meaning used in your passage.

**\*\*Meaning:\*\*** A drink made by soaking the leaves of the tea plant in hot water.

### Practice 1 — Original

> “She insists on making **\*\*tea\*\*** for everyone.”

「她堅持為大家**\*\*泡茶\*\***。」

### Practice 2

> “Would you like some **\*\*tea\*\***?”

「你想喝點**\*\*茶\*\***嗎？」

### Practice 3

> “I usually drink **\*\*tea\*\*** after lunch.”

「我通常午飯後喝**\*\*茶\*\***。」

**\*\*tea = 用茶葉加熱水沖泡而成的飲品\*\***

---

# 2. **\*\*a tea / teas = a serving or type of tea ( 一杯 / 一種茶 ) — 一杯茶 ; 茶的種類\*\***

Although **\*\*tea\*\*** is often uncountable, it can become countable when referring to:

- \* individual servings;
- \* different varieties/types.

#### ### Practice 4

> “Two \*\*teas\*\*, please.”

「請來\*\*兩杯茶\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 5

> “The shop sells many different \*\*teas\*\*.”

「這間店出售很多不同\*\*種類的茶\*\*。」

**\*\*a tea / teas = 一份茶飲，或某一種 / 多種茶葉或茶飲種類\*\***

---

# 3. **\*\*tea = tea leaves/product (茶葉) — 茶葉；茶\*\***

The word can refer not only to the prepared drink but also to the dried leaves used to make it.

#### ### Practice 6

> “Add one spoonful of \*\*tea\*\* to the pot.”

「在茶壺裡加入一匙\*\*茶葉\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 7

> “This \*\*tea\*\* comes from Taiwan.”

「這種\*\*茶葉 / 茶\*\*來自台灣。」

**\*\*tea = 用來沖泡茶飲的茶葉或茶葉產品\*\***

Context tells us whether **\*\*tea\*\*** means:

> 茶葉

or:

> 茶水 / 茶飲.

---

#### # 4. \*\*tea plant ( 茶樹 ) — 茶樹 ; 茶樹植物\*\*

The word also participates in the botanical meaning of the tea-producing plant.

#### ### Practice 8

> “Tea is grown in warm, wet climates.”

「\*\*茶樹\*\*適合在溫暖濕潤的氣候生長。」

#### ### Practice 9

> “The farm grows \*\*tea\*\* on the hillside.”

「農場在山坡上種植\*\*茶樹\*\*。」

\*\*tea = 用來生產茶葉的茶樹作物 / 植物\*\*

This belongs closely to the same botanical/product family as the tea-leaf sense.

---

#### # 5. \*\*black/green/white/oolong tea ( 不同種類的茶 ) — 紅茶 / 綠茶 / 白茶 / 烏龍茶\*\*

These are important compounds rather than separate meanings of \*\*tea\*\*.

#### ### Practice 10

> “She prefers \*\*green tea\*\*.”

「她較喜歡喝\*\*綠茶\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 11

> “Would you like black tea or oolong tea?”

「你想喝\*\*紅茶還是烏龍茶\*\*？」

\*\*X tea = 不同加工方法、品種或風格的茶飲 / 茶葉\*\*

These remain under the core “tea drink/product” meaning.

---

# 6. \*\*herbal tea ( 花草茶 / 草本飲品 ) — 花草茶 ; 草本浸泡飲品\*\*

A useful semantic extension.

Strictly speaking, many so-called \*\*herbal teas\*\* do not contain leaves from the traditional tea plant.

Instead, they may be made from:

- \* herbs;
- \* flowers;
- \* fruit;
- \* spices.

### Practice 12

> “She drinks \*\*herbal tea\*\* before bed.”

「她睡前會喝\*\*花草茶 / 草本茶飲\*\*。」

### Practice 13

> “The café offers several herbal teas.”

「咖啡店提供幾種不同的\*\*花草茶飲\*\*。」

\*\*herbal tea = 將草本植物、花、果實等用熱水浸泡而成的飲品，不一定含真正茶葉\*\*

This is a useful broadening of \*\*tea\*\*.

---

# 7. \*\*tea = meal, especially British English ( 茶點 / 一餐 ) — 茶點 ; 一餐\*\*

A major separate British-English sense.

\*\*Tea\*\* can mean:

\*\*a meal or light meal eaten in the afternoon or early evening.\*\*

### Practice 14

> “We had \*\*tea\*\* at four o’clock.”

「我們四點吃了\*\*下午茶 / 茶點\*\*。」

### ### Practice 15

> “The children had their **tea** before six.”

「孩子們六點前吃了**晚餐 / 茶餐**。」

**tea** = 英式英語中某些下午或傍晚的一餐；具體意思視地區和家庭習慣而定

This is genuinely different from merely drinking tea.

---

# 8. **afternoon tea** ( 下午茶 ) — 下午茶；下午茶點

A major cultural compound.

### ### Practice 16

> “We had **afternoon tea** at the hotel.”

「我們在酒店吃了**下午茶**。」

### ### Practice 17

> “Afternoon tea usually includes tea and small snacks.”

「**下午茶**通常包括茶飲和小食。」

**afternoon tea** = 下午享用茶飲並配以三文治、糕點等小食的一種茶點 / 社交餐飲活動

This is a meal/event, not simply the liquid drink.

---

# 9. **high tea** ( 較豐富的傍晚茶餐 ) — 傍晚茶餐；較正式的茶餐名稱

A useful British cultural expression.

### ### Practice 18

> “The guesthouse serves **high tea** in the early evening.”

「旅館在傍晚供應**high tea / 較豐富的茶餐**。」

### ### Practice 19

> “High tea traditionally includes more substantial food than afternoon tea.”

「傳統上的 **high tea** 比下午茶包含更飽肚的食物。」

**high tea** = 傳統上較接近傍晚一餐、食物比 afternoon tea 更飽肚的茶餐

Important:

> **high tea** ≠ simply a more luxurious afternoon tea

although modern commercial usage sometimes blurs the terms.

---

# 10. **tea** = evening meal ( 晚餐 ; 部分英國地區 ) — 晚飯 ; 晚餐

In some British varieties and households, especially regionally, **tea** can simply mean:

> the evening meal.

### Practice 20

> “What are we having for **tea**?”

「我們今晚**晚飯**吃甚麼？」

### Practice 21

> “Tea will be ready at six.”

「**晚飯**六點就準備好。」

**tea** = 部分英國英語中指傍晚 / 晚上的正餐

This is a major learner-relevant regional meaning.

---

# 11. **tea break** ( 茶歇 / 休息時間 ) — 茶歇 ; 短暫休息

A very common workplace compound.

### Practice 22

> “We took a **tea break** at eleven.”

「我們十一點休了一次\*\*茶歇 / 小休\*\*。」

#### ### Practice 23

> “Let’s continue after the tea break.”

「我們在\*\*茶歇\*\*後再繼續。」

**\*\*tea break = 工作 / 活動期間短暫休息喝茶、咖啡或其他飲品的時間\*\***

Importantly, people do not necessarily have to drink tea during a **\*\*tea break\*\***.

---

# 12. **\*\*tea room / tearoom (茶室) — 茶室 ; 茶館\*\***

#### ### Practice 24

> “We stopped at a small **\*\*tea room\*\***.”

「我們在一間小**\*\*茶室 / 茶館\*\***停下來。」

#### ### Practice 25

> “The museum has a traditional tearoom.”

「博物館裡有一間傳統**\*\*茶室\*\***。」

**\*\*tea room = 主要供應茶、飲品、糕點及輕食的小型餐飲場所\*\***

---

# 13. **\*\*tea ceremony (茶道 / 茶禮) — 茶道 ; 茶藝儀式\*\***

A major cultural compound.

#### ### Practice 26

> “They attended a Japanese **\*\*tea ceremony\*\***.”

「他們參加了一場日本**\*\*茶道儀式\*\***。」

#### ### Practice 27

> “The tea ceremony follows a careful sequence.”

「\*\*茶道 / 茶禮\*\*按照一套細緻程序進行。」

**\*\*tea ceremony = 以泡茶、奉茶、飲茶為核心並具有禮儀 / 文化意義的正式活動\*\***

---

# 14. **\*\*tea party (茶會) — 茶會；以茶點為主的聚會\*\***

### Practice 28

> “She invited her friends to a small **\*\*tea party\*\***.”

「她邀請朋友參加一個小型**\*\*茶會\*\***。」

### Practice 29

> “The children held a pretend tea party.”

「孩子們玩了一場假裝的**\*\*茶會遊戲\*\***。」

**\*\*tea party = 以喝茶、吃小食和社交為主的聚會\*\***

---

# 15. **\*\*tea = gossip / inside information (八卦 / 內幕消息；俚語) — 八卦；內幕\*\***

A major modern informal/slang sense.

**\*\*Meaning:\*\*** Gossip, personal information, or interesting inside information.

### Practice 30

> “What’s the **\*\*tea\*\***?”

「有甚麼**\*\*八卦 / 內幕消息\*\***？」

### Practice 31

> “She gave us all the **\*\*tea\*\*** about what happened.”

「她把事情的**\*\*八卦內幕\*\***全告訴我們了。」

**\*\*tea = 非正式俚語，指八卦消息、內幕資訊或令人感興趣的私人消息\*\***

This is completely different from the beverage sense.

---

# 16. \*\*spill the tea ( 爆料 / 講八卦 ) — 爆料 ; 把八卦說出來\*\*

A very common slang expression.

### Practice 32

> “Come on—\*\*spill the tea\*\*!”

「來吧，快\*\*爆料 / 講八卦\*\*！」

### Practice 33

> “She spilled the tea about the argument.”

「她把那場爭執的\*\*內幕八卦都說了出來\*\*。」

\*\*spill the tea = 把有趣、秘密或八卦性的資訊說出來\*\*

Informal/slang.

---

# 17. \*\*the tea ( 真相 / 內幕 ; 俚語 ) — 真實內幕\*\*

Closely related to the gossip sense.

### Practice 34

> “Here’s the real \*\*tea\*\*.”

「這才是真正的\*\*內幕 / 真相\*\*。」

### Practice 35

> “Everyone wanted to know the tea.”

「大家都想知道那件事的\*\*內幕\*\*。」

\*\*the tea = 某件事情真正有趣、私下或未公開的內情\*\*

---

# 18. \*\*not my cup of tea ( 不是我的喜好 ) — 不是我喜歡的東西\*\*

A major fixed expression strongly associated with **tea**.

#### Practice 36

> “Public speaking isn’t everyone’s **cup of tea**.”

「公開演講並不是每個人都**喜歡 / 擅長接受的事**。」

#### Practice 37

> “Horror films aren’t really my cup of tea.”

「恐怖片真的**不是我的喜好**。」

**not someone’s cup of tea = 不是某人喜歡、感興趣或適合的事物**

The idiom does not literally concern tea preference.

---

# 19. **someone’s cup of tea ( 某人的喜好 ) — 正合某人喜好**

The positive form is possible, though the negative is more common.

#### Practice 38

> “Quiet cafés are more my **cup of tea**.”

「安靜的咖啡店比較**合我的喜好**。」

#### Practice 39

> “If you enjoy history, this museum may be your cup of tea.”

「如果你喜歡歷史，這間博物館可能會**很合你胃口 / 喜好**。」

**someone’s cup of tea = 某人喜歡、感興趣或適合的事物**

---

# 20. **tea bag ( 茶包 ) — 茶包**

A common transparent but useful compound.

#### Practice 40

> “Put the **tea bag** in the cup.”

「把**茶包**放進杯裡。」

#### ### Practice 41

> “I usually use one tea bag per cup.”

「我通常每杯用一個**茶包**。」

**tea bag** = 裝有茶葉、可直接放進熱水沖泡的小袋

---

#### # 21. **teapot** ( 茶壺 ) — 茶壺

#### ### Practice 42

> “She poured the tea from the **teapot**.”

「她從**茶壺**裡倒茶。」

#### ### Practice 43

> “The teapot was already on the table.”

「**茶壺**已經放在桌上。」

**teapot** = 專門用來沖泡 / 盛裝茶飲的壺

---

#### # 22. **teacup** ( 茶杯 ) — 茶杯

#### ### Practice 44

> “She placed three **teacups** on the table.”

「她在桌上放了三隻**茶杯**。」

#### ### Practice 45

> “The teacup is very delicate.”

「這隻**茶杯**很精緻。」

**\*\*teacup = 通常用來飲茶的杯子\*\***

---

# 23. **\*\*tea leaves ( 茶葉 ) — 茶葉\*\***

### Practice 46

> “The **\*\*tea leaves\*\*** opened slowly in the hot water.”

「**\*\*茶葉\*\***在熱水中慢慢舒展。」

### Practice 47

> “These tea leaves have a strong aroma.”

「這些**\*\*茶葉\*\***香氣很濃。」

**\*\*tea leaves = 用來沖泡茶飲的茶樹葉片\*\***

---

## Important distinction: **\*\*tea = drink vs tea = leaves\*\***

### Drink:

> “The tea is too hot.”

= 茶水太熱。

### Leaves/product:

> “This tea comes from China.”

could mean:

> 這種茶葉 / 茶品來自中國。

Context determines whether **\*\*tea\*\*** means the prepared beverage or the tea product.

---

## Important distinction: **\*\*tea vs herbal tea\*\***

### **\*\*tea\*\***

in the strict botanical sense is made from the tea plant.

### \*\*herbal tea\*\*

may be made from:

- \* chamomile;
- \* peppermint;
- \* fruit;
- \* flowers;
- \* other herbs.

So \*\*herbal tea\*\* uses \*\*tea\*\* in the broader everyday sense of:

> a hot infused drink.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*tea vs coffee\*\*

Both are beverages, but their grammar behaves similarly:

- > some tea
- > some coffee

and countably in café ordering:

- > two teas
- > two coffees

meaning:

> two servings/cups.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*tea vs afternoon tea\*\*

### \*\*tea\*\*

may simply mean the beverage.

### \*\*afternoon tea\*\*

is a meal/social occasion involving:

- \* tea;
- \* sandwiches;
- \* cakes;
- \* pastries, etc.

So:

> drink tea

is not automatically:

> have afternoon tea.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*afternoon tea vs high tea\*\*

These are often confused.

### \*\*afternoon tea\*\*

traditionally:

> tea + lighter foods in the afternoon.

### \*\*high tea\*\*

traditionally:

> a more substantial meal in the late afternoon/early evening.

Modern hospitality marketing sometimes uses the labels loosely, but historically they are not simply “ordinary tea” versus “fancy tea.”

---

## Important distinction: \*\*tea = drink vs tea = evening meal\*\*

In some British English:

> “Tea is ready.”

may mean:

> 「晚飯準備好了。」

not:

> 「茶泡好了。」

Context and regional usage matter greatly.

---

## Important distinction: **tea vs dinner**

In some households:

> **tea**

= evening meal.

In others:

> **dinner**

= evening meal.

And **dinner** itself can historically/regionally refer to the main meal at midday.

These meal names vary considerably by region, household, and social convention.

---

## Important distinction: **make tea vs make a tea**

### **make tea**

= prepare tea generally.

This is the natural expression in your passage:

> “She makes tea.”

### **make a tea**

can be possible when referring to one serving/type, but it is much less neutral.

For learners, the safest default is:

> **make tea**

---

## Important distinction: **\*\*make tea vs brew tea\*\***

### **\*\*make tea\*\***

= everyday broad expression for preparing tea.

### **\*\*brew tea\*\***

= emphasizes the steeping/infusion process.

> “She made tea.”

everyday.

> “Let the tea brew for three minutes.”

focuses on extraction/steeping.

---

## Important distinction: **\*\*tea = gossip vs gossip\*\***

### **\*\*gossip\*\***

is the broad ordinary word.

### **\*\*tea\*\***

is slangier and often playful, especially for:

\* juicy information;

\* social drama;

\* inside details.

> “Tell me the gossip.”

neutral/informal.

> “Spill the tea.”

much more slangy/playful.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*spill the tea vs tell the truth\*\*

### \*\*spill the tea\*\*

= reveal gossip/inside details.

### \*\*tell the truth\*\*

= say what is factually true.

The “tea” may contain truth, opinion, rumor, or gossip.

So the phrases are not equivalent.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*tea vs the tea — slang\*\*

In ordinary beverage use:

> “The tea is cold.”

= 那壺 / 杯茶涼了。

In slang:

> “What’s the tea?”

= 有甚麼八卦 / 內幕？

Only context tells us which meaning is intended.

---

## Important distinction: \*\*cup of tea literal vs idiomatic\*\*

### Literal:

> “I made her a cup of tea.”

= 我替她泡了一杯茶。

### Idiomatic:

> “That’s not my cup of tea.”

= 那不是我的喜好。

The idiomatic meaning cannot be understood simply from the literal beverage words.

---

## Important distinction: **tea break vs break**

### **break**

= any pause from work/activity.

### **tea break**

= traditionally a short break for tea or refreshments.

In modern usage, people may drink:

- \* coffee;
- \* water;
- \* nothing at all.

The compound refers to the type of break, not necessarily what is consumed.

---

## Important distinction: **tea room vs café**

### **tea room**

traditionally emphasizes:

- \* tea;
- \* cakes;
- \* light food;
- \* quieter atmosphere.

### **café**

is broader and commonly serves:

- \* coffee;
- \* tea;
- \* meals;
- \* snacks.

There is substantial overlap.

---

### ## Family-extension sweep

The practical **tea** family is not derivationally large; its richness comes mainly from countability, meal senses, cultural compounds, and slang:

- \* **tea** — beverage = 茶 / 茶水
- \* **a tea / teas** = 一杯 / 幾杯茶 ; 茶的種類
- \* **tea** — leaves/product = 茶葉 / 茶品
- \* **tea** — plant/crop = 茶樹 / 茶作物
- \* **green/black/oolong tea** = 綠茶 / 紅茶 / 烏龍茶
- \* **herbal tea** = 花草茶 / 草本浸泡飲品
- \* **tea** — meal = 茶點 / 一餐
- \* **afternoon tea** = 下午茶
- \* **high tea** = 傍晚較豐富的茶餐
- \* **tea** — evening meal = 部分英國英語中的晚餐
- \* **tea break** = 茶歇 / 小休
- \* **tea room / tearoom** = 茶室 / 茶館
- \* **tea ceremony** = 茶道 / 茶禮
- \* **tea party** = 茶會
- \* **tea** — slang = 八卦 / 內幕
- \* **spill the tea** = 爆料 / 講八卦
- \* **the tea** = 真實內幕 / 八卦消息
- \* **someone's cup of tea** = 某人的喜好
- \* **not my cup of tea** = 不是我的喜好
- \* **tea bag** = 茶包
- \* **teapot** = 茶壺
- \* **teacup** = 茶杯
- \* **tea leaves** = 茶葉

The main semantic branches are:

> **tea as a drink/product**

> **tea as a meal**

> **tea as gossip/inside information**

plus culturally important compounds and idioms.

---

### ## Master comparison

| Form / sense                        | MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| -----                               | -----                                 |
| <b>**tea — beverage**</b>           | 用茶葉加入熱水浸泡而成的飲品                        |
| <b>**a tea / teas**</b>             | 一份茶飲，或一種 / 多種茶葉或茶飲種類                  |
| <b>**tea — leaves/product**</b>     | 用來沖泡飲品的茶葉或茶葉產品                        |
| <b>**tea — crop/plant**</b>         | 用來生產茶葉的茶樹作物                           |
| <b>**herbal tea**</b>               | 用草本、花、果實等浸泡而成、未必含真正茶葉的熱飲              |
| <b>**tea — meal**</b>               | 英式英語中下午 / 傍晚享用的一餐或茶點                  |
| <b>**afternoon tea**</b>            | 下午享用茶飲並配搭糕點、三文治等小食的茶點 / 社交活動          |
| <b>**high tea**</b>                 | 傳統上在傍晚享用、食物較豐富飽肚的一餐                   |
| <b>**tea — evening meal**</b>       | 部分英國地區 / 家庭對傍晚正餐的稱呼                   |
| <b>**tea break**</b>                | 工作 / 活動期間短暫休息喝飲品的時間                   |
| <b>**tea room**</b>                 | 主要供應茶、飲品、糕點和輕食的小型餐飲場所                 |
| <b>**tea ceremony**</b>             | 以泡茶、奉茶和飲茶為核心並具有文化 / 禮儀意義的活動           |
| <b>**tea party**</b>                | 以飲茶、吃小食和社交為主的聚會                       |
| <b>**tea — slang**</b>              | 八卦消息、私人內幕或有趣的未公開資訊                    |
| <b>**spill the tea**</b>            | 把八卦、秘密或內幕消息說出來                        |
| <b>**someone's cup of tea**</b>     | 某人喜歡、感興趣或覺得適合的事物                      |
| <b>**not someone's cup of tea**</b> | 不是某人喜歡 / 感興趣的事物                       |
| <b>**tea bag**</b>                  | 裝有茶葉、可直接放進熱水沖泡的小袋                     |
| <b>**teapot**</b>                   | 用來沖泡 / 盛裝茶飲的茶壺                        |
| <b>**teacup**</b>                   | 通常用來飲茶的杯子                             |
| <b>**tea leaves**</b>               | 用來沖泡茶飲的茶葉葉片                           |

---

## For your original passage

> “Whenever I visit, she insists on making **\*\*tea\*\*** and cutting fruit for everyone...”

The exact meaning is:

**\*\*tea = 用茶葉和熱水沖泡而成的飲品\*\***

and:

**\*\*make tea = 泡茶 / 準備茶飲\*\***

The passage does **\*\*not\*\*** use:

> tea = 下午茶 / 一餐

and certainly not:

> tea = 八卦 / 內幕消息.

The context is straightforward:

- > family members visit
- > → grandmother welcomes them
- > → she makes tea and cuts fruit
- > → these small acts show affection.

So **tea** contributes to the description of her hospitality, although the lexical meaning itself remains the ordinary beverage sense.

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **drink tea**

> = 喝茶

> **make tea**

> = 泡茶

> **tea leaves**

> = 茶葉

> **two teas**

> = 兩杯 / 兩份茶

> **herbal tea**

> = 花草茶

> **afternoon tea**

> = 下午茶

> **high tea**

> = 傍晚較豐富的茶餐

> **tea is ready**

> = 在部分英國英語可指「晚飯準備好了」

> **tea break**

> = 茶歇 / 小休

> **tea ceremony**

> = 茶道 / 茶禮

> **What's the tea?**

> = 有甚麼八卦 / 內幕？

> **\*\*spill the tea\*\***

> = 爆料 / 講八卦

> **\*\*not my cup of tea\*\***

> = 不是我的喜好

So **\*\*tea\*\*** is richer than simply:

> **\*\*tea = 茶\*\***

and in your original passage it specifically means:

**\*\*“the hot drink she prepares for family members as part of her habitual hospitality and care.”\*\***